

SKITCH & GRIP BOODLE

EPISODE 12 — THE LAST CRUMB



CHAPTER 7: CRUMBS & CONTRADICTIONS

BENEATH THE BUILDING,
THE DREAM NETWORK
STIRS.

THE MIDNIGHT BELL,
ROLLS AHEAD, RINGING SOFTLY
WHENEVER IT STRIKES A JOINT
IN THE TRACK.

DING...
DING...

I'LL
CATCH YOU,
MIDNIGHT
BELL!

WHOA...
GIANT
DREAM
BISCUIT...
♡

IT'S
ALMOST
TOO
BEAUTIFUL
TO EAT...
♡

うっとり...

BOODLE.
FOCUS.

THE BELL
DOESN'T
WAIT.

AWW...
FIIINE...

THIS WAY.
TRACK
FORKS IN
THREE
AHEAD.

DING...
DING...

MEMORY
LANE

FORGOTTEN
FILES

WHAT IF
BOULEVARD

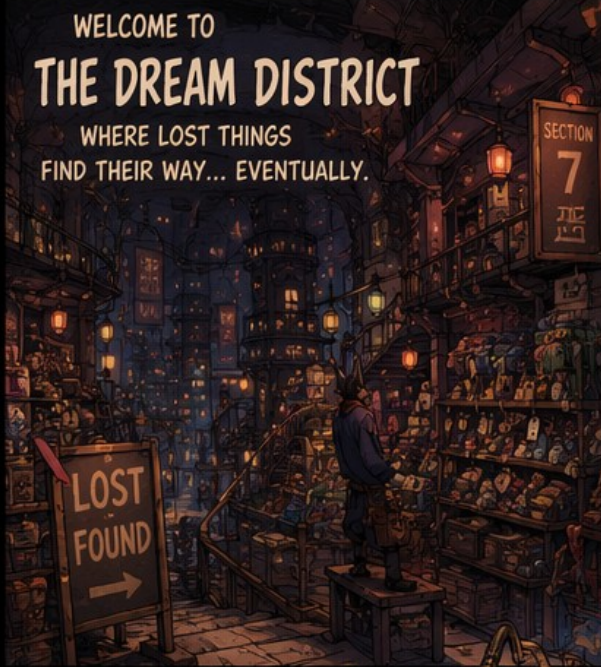
LEFT
LEADS TO
REGRET.
RIGHT TO
FANTASY.
MIDDLE...

...TO
SOMETHING
WORSE.

LET'S
JUST FOLLOW
THE BELL.

WELCOME TO THE DREAM DISTRICT

WHERE LOST THINGS
FIND THEIR WAY... EVENTUALLY.



"SIGH" ALL ITEMS
MISPLACED WITHIN
THE BUILDING
EVENTUALLY PASS
THROUGH HERE.

SOCKS, KEYS,
RECEIPTS, DREAMS...

IF IT'S LOST,
IT SHOWS UP.



DO WE HAVE
A RECORD OF
A BELL?

NOPE.

NOT OFFICIALLY.

IF IT WAS NEVER
LOST, JUST...
IN TRANSIT...

THEN WE DON'T
LOG IT.

THAT'S OUTSIDE
OUR JURISDICTION.



BOODLE.
FOCUS.

WE'RE HERE
FOR A BELL.

SECTION
SNACKS

HM?

WHAT'S
THAT?



WHOA.

SNACKS!

THE GREAT
SNACK PILE
(NO ONE CLAIMS THESE)



WEEEEEEEE!



WHUMP!



...YOU'RE
WEARING A SOCK.

WORTH
IT.



FOCUS,
BOODLE.

BELLS DON'T
HIDE IN SNACKS.

UNLESS THEY'RE
DESSERT BELLS.

MMMPH.
MAYBE.



THE
BELL'S ENTIRE
JOURNEY...

EVERY STEP
MATCHES.

MECHANICAL TRACKING BOARD

IT'S
ALL
HERE!



THIS...
THIS PROVES
EVERYTHING.

AND THIS—
THIS IS THE
CRIMINAL!

HE'S MOCKING ME!
THIS IS PERSONAL!

THE BELL HAS SPOKEN.
THE TRAIL IS COMPLETE.
THE TRUTH IS UNDENIABLE.



THE BASEMENT DREAM CAFÉ

OPEN ALL NIGHT
COFFEE. PIE. SOUP.
AND ONE MYSTERY.

Tonight's
Special
- Coffee
- Pie
- Soup
- ???

DREAMS
BREW HERE



THE BELL.
IT HAS TO
BE UNDER
THAT DOME.
THAT'S WHY
IT'S THE ONLY
THING THEY
WOULDN'T
NAME.



KLANG...



NOM!



CHOMP!



GOBBLE!



SLURP!



ECHOES & ELIXIRS

CASE FILE #27:
THE CHIMES OF CHAOS



...WAIT.

SKITCH HAS
KNOWN TOO MUCH
THIS WHOLE
CASE.



A-HA!
I KNEW IT!

SKITCH!
YOU'VE BEEN
HIDING THE
TRUTH THIS
WHOLE TIME!
I KNEW YOU
WERE
SUSPICIOUS!



OH, BOODLE...
I'LL GLADLY CLEAR
THINGS UP.
PICK YOUR
POISON.



1 ALIBI: THE DOCKS

I WAS ON THE
WEST DOCK AT
MIDNIGHT.
ASK ORIC.



2 ALIBI: THE LIBRARY

I WAS IN THE
ARCHIVES WITH
ELDER NIBS.
WE STUDIED
BELL HISTORIES.



3 ALIBI: THE TEAHOUSE

I WAS HAVING
TEA WITH THE
MAYOR.
WE DISCUSSED
CIVIC HARMONY.



4 CONFESSION

FINE. I RUNG
THE BELL.
I'M THE BELL
BANDIT.
HAPPY NOW?



5 MAP TO NOWHERE

BEHOLD! A MAP
TO THE HIDDEN
BELL VAULT OF
SILENCE PEAK.



6 MOTIVE: CIVIC BELLS

THE BELLS REPRESENT
OPPRESSION! THEIR
RINGING MINDS THE
PEOPLE TO OBEY!
I SEEK FREEDOM
THROUGH SILENCE!



THAT MAKES
PERFECT
SENSE!



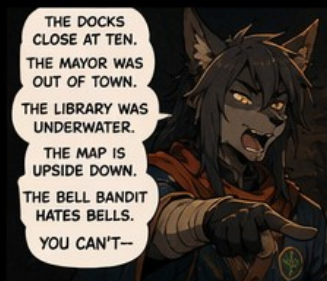
...OR IT DOES
UNTIL YOU THINK
ABOUT IT FOR
TWO SECONDS.



AH! OF COURSE!
THE SECOND
ALIBI IS THE
TRUE ONE!



NO. THE FIRST.



THE DOCKS
CLOSE AT TEN.
THE MAYOR WAS
OUT OF TOWN.
THE LIBRARY WAS
UNDERWATER.
THE MAP IS
UPSIDE DOWN.
THE BELL BANDIT
HATES BELLS.
YOU CAN'T—



CONTRADICTION
IS THE HEART
OF MYSTERY,
DEAR WOLF.



LATER!

WAIT! THAT'S
NOT EVEN AN
ALIBI!



STOP, SKITCH!
FOR THE SAKE OF
JUSTICE!
...AND ALSO
BECAUSE YOU SAID
YOU WANTED
TO BE CHASED!



WELL, YOU
GOT ONE!
CATCH ME
IF YOU CAN,
DETECTIVE!



THIS IS
THE
BEST CASE
EVER!

WORTH EVERY
SECOND!
...EVEN THE
CONTRADICTIONS!

ANOTHER PERFECTLY
UNSOLVED CASE!

MORAL: WHEN IN DOUBT, CHOOSE CHAOS.

DUMBWAITER
SERVICE SHAFT
Level 7-17

THE CHASE
DESCENDS.

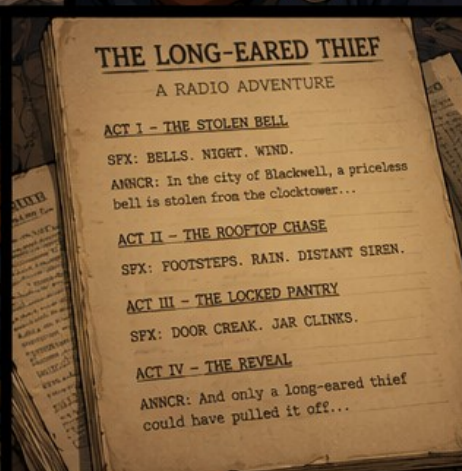


ATTIC LEVEL



THE DREAM ATTIC ARCHIVE

EVERYTHING THAT
HAS BEEN FORGOTTEN...
STORED UNTIL
IT'S NEEDED AGAIN.



THE CASE OF THE MISSING BELL

CHAPTER 7: REEL SUS



MEMORIES DON'T LIE.



CAMERAS DO.

TO BE CONTINUED...

THE TRUTH IS NEVER THAT SIMPLE!



THE TRUE EVENTS

The Night of the Mystery Sounds

CASE FILE: #27-B

SUBJECT:
BOODLE

SPECIES:
RABBIT-LIKE
(UNCONFIRMED)



After reviewing all evidence, this is what really happened. A simple case of a very good boy.

1. BOODLE WAS ASLEEP
IN THE LOBBY...



2. THE SMELL OF COOLING
PASTRIES WOKE HIM.



3. HALF-ASLEEP, HE WANDERED
INTO THE LOBBY.



4. IN THE DIM LIGHT,
THE BRASS BELL LOOKED
LIKE A GIANT CARAMEL.



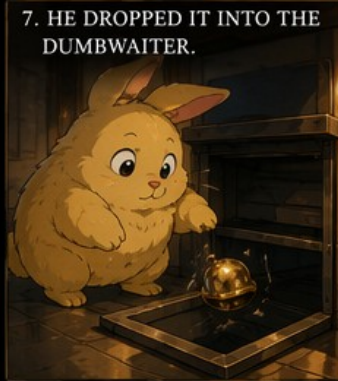
5. IT TASTED
EVEN BETTER.



6. THE BELL RANG
IN PROTEST!



7. HE DROPPED IT INTO THE
DUMBWAITER.



8. HIS FUMBLING
ACTIVATED THE LIFT.



9. THE BELL TRAVELED THROUGH
THE ENTIRE BUILDING...



10. ...CREATING EVERY MYSTERIOUS SOUND FROM THE CASE.



11. BOODLE FOLLOWED IT,
SAMPLE-TASTING ALONG
THE WAY.



12. FINALLY, HE CARRIED
IT BACK TO THE LOBBY.



13. HE FELL ASLEEP...
STILL HOLDING IT.



THE NEXT MORNING...



CASE CLOSED.

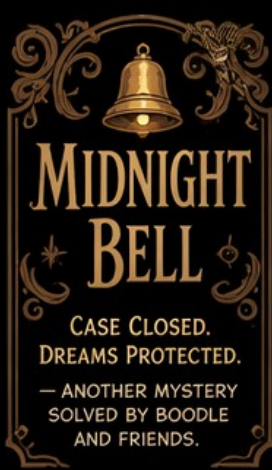
VERDICT:
ACCUSED OF CUTENESS.

SENTENCE:
ALL THE TREATS.

**GOOD BOY
CONFIRMED**







MIDNIGHT BELL

CASE CLOSED.
DREAMS PROTECTED.

— ANOTHER MYSTERY
SOLVED BY BOODLE
AND FRIENDS.

THE MIDNIGHT BELL RETURNS
TO THE GRAND DREAM LOBBY.



HOW DID THE
CULPRIT ENTER
A LOCKED
LOBBY?



EXCELLENT
QUESTION,
COUNCILOR!
ALLOW ME!



THE CULPRIT
DIDN'T ENTER
THE LOBBY...



THE CULPRIT
WAS ALREADY
INSIDE!

GASP!



BRILLIANT
AS EVER,
BOODLE.



JUST DOING
MY DUTY!
HEH HEH!



?SIGH?...



LET'S HEAR IT FOR
OUR DREAM TEAM!
AND OUR UNSUNG
HEROES!



AND A SPECIAL THANK YOU TO
NIBBS, OUR NIGHT CUSTODIAN!
YOUR QUICK THINKING KEPT THE
REAL DUMBWAITER MECHANISM
SAFE AND SOUND.

OH, IT
WASN'T
NOTHING...

THE DREAM LOBBY
IS SAFE BECAUSE
WE LOOK OUT FOR
EACH OTHER.



IT WASN'T
NOTHING.
IT WAS
EVERYTHING.

THANK YOU,
NIBBS.



ANOTHER MYSTERY SOLVED.
ANOTHER NIGHT PROTECTED.
TOGETHER.
THAT IS THE DREAM LOBBY WAY.



THE END.

THE GRAND DREAM LOBBY CLOCK APPROACHES MIDNIGHT.

SO IT ENDS TONIGHT...

BOODLE...

WILL YOU RING THE MIDNIGHT BELL?

ME?

WITH HONOR.

I ACCEPT THE DUTY...

...AND RING THE HOUR TRUE.

RIIIIIIIING

RIIIIIIIING

...HOME.

BOODLE
DETECTIVE
AGENCY

DETECTIVE BOODLE
DREAMS. CASES. CARROTS.

MORNING RETURNS
TO WRENWICK.

B-BOODLE...
THAT TRAY IS
BENT. THE ROPE
IS DESTROYED.
AND THIS BILL IS
NOT FRACTIONAL.

NOTES.

WRENWICK REPAIRS	
Dumbwaiter Tray	\$75.00
Rope Replacement	\$30.00
Emergency Labor	\$45.00
Disruption Fee	\$50.00
TOTAL	\$200.00
PAYABLE TO WRENWICK BY END OF DAY.	

THE BELL...
THE CRUMBS...
THE ROPE...
THE TRAY...

WAIT... I DID
ALL THAT?

HMM.

CRUMBS
DON'T LIE.

TIME TO
IDENTIFY THE
CULPRIT.

SUSPECT
PORTRAIT:

ADDING A
MOUSTACHE
FOR DISCRETION.

CASE CLOSED.

...PROBABLY.

THE END. 🐾